

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

Index #

Date of filing:

-----X
ALISTER THOMAS,

Plaintiff,

Plaintiff designates
Kings County as the
place of trial

-against-

Basis of the venue is
Plaintiff's residence

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM
PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760 and JOHN DOES-Police
Officers as yet unidentified,

Defendants.

SUMMONS

Plaintiff resides at:
202 East 52nd Street
Brooklyn, NY 11203

County of Kings

TO THE ABOVE NAMED DEFENDANTS:

YOU ARE HEREBY SUMMONED to answer the complaint in this action and to serve a copy of your answer, or, if the complaint is not served with this summons, to serve a notice of appearance, on the Plaintiff's Attorney within 20 days after the service of this summons, exclusive of the day of service (or within 30 days after the service is complete if this summons is not personally delivered to you within the State of New York); and in the case of your failure to appear or answer, judgment will be taken against you by default for the relief demanded herein.

DEFENDANT'S ADDRESS:

THE CITY OF NEW YORK
100 Church Street
New York, NY 10007

PLAINTIFF'S ATTORNEYS:

RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS.
16 Court Street, Suite 1717
Brooklyn, New York 11241
(718)522-1020

POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-
Shield No. 12760
c/o New York City Police Department, 67th
Precinct
2820 Snyder Avenue
Brooklyn, NY 11226

Dated: Brooklyn, New York
July 3, 2018

SUPREME COURT OF THE STATE OF NEW YORK
COUNTY OF KINGS

-----X
ALISTER THOMAS,

Index No.:

Plaintiff,

-against-

VERIFIED COMPLAINT

THE CITY OF NEW YORK, POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM
PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760 and JOHN DOES-Police
Officers as yet unidentified,

Defendants.
-----X

Plaintiff by his attorneys, **RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS.**, complaining of the
defendants herein, upon information and belief, respectfully show to this Court, and alleges as
follows:

**AS AND FOR A FIRST CAUSE OF ACTION
ON BEHALF OF ALISTER THOMAS**

1. That at all times hereinafter mentioned, plaintiff **ALISTER THOMAS**, was and
still is a resident of the County of Kings, City and State of New York.
2. That all times hereinafter mentioned, the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**,
was and still is a municipal corporation, duly organized and existing pursuant to the laws of the
State of New York.
3. That the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, maintains a police force known
as the NEW YORK CITY POLICE DEPARTMENT.
4. That prior hereto on November 13, 2017, and within the time prescribed by law, a
sworn Notice of Claim stating, among other things, the time when and place where the injuries

and damages were sustained, together with plaintiff's demands for adjustment or payment thereof, and that thereafter **THE CITY OF NEW YORK** refused or neglected for more than (30) days and up to the commencement of this action to make any adjustment or payment thereof, and that thereafter, and within the time provided by law, this action was commenced.

5. That on May 25, 2018, pursuant to the General Municipal Law, a Statutory 50-H hearing of plaintiff was held.

6. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, employed **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, as agents, servants and/or employees.

7. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, was lawfully present at or about the premises known as 198 East 52nd Street, in the County of Kings, City and State of New York.

8. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, was assaulted, battered and falsely arrested by defendants, **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, who were acting within the scope of their employment with the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, at the aforementioned location.

9. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the aforementioned false arrest was performed knowingly, intentionally and willfully.

10. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon

information and belief the defendants, **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, who assaulted, battered and falsely arrested the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, were acting within the scope of their employment with the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**.

11. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the assault and battery on the plaintiff was without probable cause and was not the result of an appropriate arrest.

12. By reason of said assault and battery the plaintiff **ALISTER THOMAS** was caused to suffer severe and serious injuries in and about diverse parts of the person, and suffered great pain, distress, mental shock, mental anguish and psychological trauma and was otherwise injured.

13. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A SECOND CAUSE OF ACTION FOR NEGLIGENT
HIRING AND RETENTION ON BEHALF OF ALISTER THOMAS**

14. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "13" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

15. That the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, did not exercise reasonable care and diligence in the selection, engagement, employment and training of their agents, servants, and employees and were negligent in the hiring, training and retention of the defendants, **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, who assaulted, battered, falsely arrested and violated the civil rights of the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**.

16. That the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, had prior knowledge of the inappropriate, unlawful, and improper conduct of the defendants, **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, and continued to employ them and allowed them to be in contact with the public at large.

17. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A THIRD CAUSE OF ACTION FOR FALSE
ARREST ON BEHALF OF ALISTER THOMAS**

18. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1 through "17" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

19. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the defendants, **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, were working within the scope of their employment and authority with the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, when they arrested and confined the plaintiff **ALISTER THOMAS**.

20. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, the arrest and confinement was without probable cause nor based on reasonable grounds and not founded upon an arrest warrant.

21. That as a result of the aforesaid false arrest and confinement, plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, sustained serious permanent personal injuries along with humiliation, shame, indignity, damage to reputation and credit and suffered emotional and physical distress, emotional

distress and injuries.

22. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A FOURTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR FALSE
IMPRISONMENT ON BEHALF OF ALISTER THOMAS**

23. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1 through "22" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

24. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, were acting within the scope of their employment when they, without justification and without probable cause, imprisoned the plaintiff **ALISTER THOMAS**.

25. That the defendants, **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, while acting within the scope of their employment, intentionally confined the plaintiff against his will and said confinement was not privileged.

26. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A FIFTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR INTENTIONAL
AND NEGLIGENT INFLICTION OF EMOTIONAL
DISTRESS ON BEHALF OF ALISTER THOMAS**

27. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "26" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at

length herein.

28. That the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, including but not limited to **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, acted intentionally, recklessly and with utter disregard to the consequences of their actions and caused severe emotional distress to the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS** through their actions.

29. Said actions exceeded all reasonable bounds of decency, were outrageous and shocking and resulted in severe emotional distress to the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**.

30. That as a result of said intentional and negligent acts, the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, become sick, sore, lame and disabled, received severe and serious injuries in and about diverse parts of his person and suffered great physical pain, distress, mental shock, mental anguish and psychological trauma and was otherwise injured.

31. By reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A SIXTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR MALICIOUS
PROSECUTION ON BEHALF OF ALISTER THOMAS**

32. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "31" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

33. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, defendants, **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, within the scope of their employment, without justification, without probable cause, created and submitted an erroneous

police report in an effort to cover up the aforesaid and initiate a prosecution in bad faith.

34. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, defendants, **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, were acting within the scope of their employment, maliciously prosecuted the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**.

35. That on September 23, 2017, and at all times hereinafter mentioned and upon information and belief, as a result of the aforesaid malicious prosecution, plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS** sustained serious, permanent, personal injuries along with humiliation, shame, indignity, damage to reputation and credit, legal fees, loss of employment opportunities and suffered emotional and physical distress and injury.

36. By reason of the foregoing, plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

**AS AND FOR A SEVENTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR CIVIL
RIGHTS VIOLATION ON BEHALF OF ALISTER THOMAS**

37. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "36" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

38. The defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, through policies, practices and customs, directly caused the constitutional violation suffered by plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**.

39. The defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, through its police department, has had and still has hiring practices that it knows will lead to the hiring of the police officers, including but not limited to **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, lacking the intellectual capacity and moral fortitude to

discharge their duties in accordance with the constitution and is indifferent to the consequences.

40. The defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, through its police department, has *de facto quota* policy that encourages unlawful stops, unlawful searches, false arrests, the fabrication of evidence and perjury.

41. The defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, at all relevant times, was, upon information and belief, aware that these individual defendants, including but not limited to **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, routinely commit constitutional violations such as those at issue here and has failed to change its policies, practices and customs to stop this behavior.

42. The defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, at all relevant times, was aware that these individual defendants, including but not limited to **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, are unfit officers who have previously committed the acts alleged herein and/or have a propensity for unconstitutional conduct.

43. As a direct and proximate result of this unlawful conduct, the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, sustained the damages hereinbefore alleged.

**AS AND FOR AN EIGHTH CAUSE OF ACTION FOR
PUNITIVE DAMAGES ON BEHALF OF ALISTER THOMAS**

44. The plaintiff repeats and realleges each and every allegation set forth above numbered "1" through "43" inclusive with the same force and effect as if more fully set forth at length herein.

45. The actions of the defendants herein-above alleged, were malicious, willful and grossly negligent.

46. That the defendant, **THE CITY OF NEW YORK**, authorized, permitted and ratified the unlawful and negligent acts of their agents, servants and/or employees, including but not limited to **POLICE OFFICER WILLIAM PUGLIESE-Shield No. 12760** and **JOHN DOES-Police Officers** as yet unidentified, herein-above alleged.

47. By the reason of the foregoing, the plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, sustained damages in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all the lower Courts.

WHEREFORE, plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **First** Cause of Action; plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Second** Cause of Action; plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Third** Cause of Action; plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Fourth** Cause of Action; plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Fifth** Cause of Action; plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS**, demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Court on the **Sixth** Cause of Action; plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS** demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Seventh** Cause of Action; plaintiff, **ALISTER THOMAS** demands judgment both compensatory and exemplary in an amount exceeding the jurisdictional limits of all lower Courts on the **Eight** Cause of Action;

together with attorneys' fees, and the costs and disbursements of this action.

DATED: Brooklyn, New York
July 3, 2018

Yours, etc.,

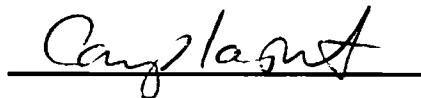
SCOTT RYNECKI, ESQ.
RUBENSTEIN & RYNECKI, ESQS.
Attorneys for Plaintiff
16 Court Street Suite 1717
Brooklyn, New York 11241
(718) 522-1020

VERIFICATION BY AFFIDAVIT

STATE OF NEW YORK, COUNTY OF KINGS ss:

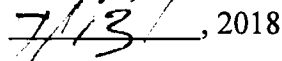
ALISTER THOMAS, being duly sworn, says:

I am a Plaintiff In the action herein: I have read the annexed



and know the contents thereof, and the same are true to my knowledge, except those matters therein which are stated to be alleged upon information and belief, and as to those matters I believe them to be true. My belief as to those matters therein not stated upon knowledge, is based upon facts, records, and other pertinent information contained in my personal files.

Dated: Brooklyn, New York

 7/13, 2018
ALISTER THOMASSubscribed and sworn to before me
this 13th day of July, 2018

NOTARY PUBLIC

CHRISTOPHER VITORATOS
Commissioner of Deeds, City of New York
Number: 4-7212
Certificate Filed in New York County
Commission Expires June 1, 2020